54. Kane (1994): vol. V, pt I, 527. A similar disdain is evident in a Buddhist legend aptly called *Nakkhata Jataka*. In this, a town family loses out on a country girl whom they want wedded to their son because the family's favoured ascetic maintains out of pique that the stars are not favourable on that particular day. The family of the girl, having made all the required arrangements, then marry her off to someone else. The advice of a wise man in the town at the end of the tale, sums up the story's attitude to 'lucky days' and planetary dispositions:

'The fool may watch for "days,"
Yet luck shall always miss;
"'Tis luck itself is luck's own star
What can mere stars achieve?'
See Cowell (1990 reprint): I, 124–6.

55. *AS* I.9.9. Kangle (1972): pt II, 18.

56. 'Nalakasutta', *Sutta Nipata* 11, in Chalmers (1931): 165–73.

57. *Sutta Nipata* 11.690. See Chalmers (1931): 167.

58. Goswami (2001): 99–105.

59. Cowell and Thomas (1968): 109–10.

Notes to Chapter 2: Pataliputra and the Prince

1. Beal (1884): vol. III, 332–3.

2. It is surprising that Xuanzang got this basic fact wrong. One wonders if the Chinese translations of the *Ashokavadana*, with which he must have been familiar, had omitted the section on Ashoka's birth in which his conception is described in some detail.

3. Watters (1904–5): vol. II, 87.

4. Strong (1989): 8.

5. Beal (1884): vol. III, 327. This is Book VIII, which has a large section on Pataliputra and Ashoka.

6. Strong (1989): 7.

7. There were two Chinese translations of versions of the *Ashokavadana*, one going back to *c*. 300 CE and another compiled in 512 CE. See Strong (1989): 16, n.46.